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CEO / CISO / Associate Director / Global IT Manager / Head of IT / IT Manager

MBA in International Business from Wales Bridge University, California, USA

Cyber Security Compliance / Cloud & / IT Infrastructure / Project Management / Customer engagements
Technical Operations and Support / Sales

Enterprising leader with a career history of successfully directing IT Infrastructure Cyber Security Management and steering initiatives geared towards implementing World Class Systems, lowering costs, improving IT operations, processes & controls.

PROFILE SUMMARY

- 15 years of experience in IT leadership, project management, service delivery, and infrastructure development across multiple platforms (AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, M365 and SAAS platforms).
- Expertise in IT & Datacenter Operations, solution design, migrations, SDLC, and managed services portfolio management. EUC and user experience management, onboarding, and resources management
- Certified Scrum Master, Agile Project Integrator, Prince II Practitioner, and ITIL v3 Expert.
- Proven track record in cost reduction (saving US\$ 150,000 annually through Datacenter optimization).
- I am skilled in stakeholder management, budgeting (OPEX & CAPEX), and compliance management (ISO 27001, SOC II, PCI-DSS, HIPAA, CCPA, GDPR). Strong multiple vendor and services management
- Hands-on experience with cloud infrastructure, server/network administration, and disaster recovery solutions. Cloud operation management and Client’s infrastructure management, managed services
- Strong background in pre-sales, DevOps, solution design, client presentation and M&A activities.
- Directed strategic planning and process development to enhance operational efficiency and foster innovation. Experienced in risk analysis, resource management, and project lifecycle management.
- Strong leadership skills, skilled in developing and motivating high-performing, cross-functional teams.

CORE COMPETENCIES

IT Infrastructure Management	Cloud and DevOps Operations	Compliance & Audit management
Planning, Scheduling & Controlling	Server/ System Administration	Network & Storage management
Pre-sales, Budgeting & Cost Control	Technical Support/ Documentation	Clients engagement and support

ORGANISATIONAL EXPERIENCE

July’ 25 – JAN ‘26 CEO – Woodapple AI LLP (Cyber Security Startup)

Cyber Security Compliance & IT Governance

- Dual-hat executive serving as CEO at Woodapple AI LLP and CISO for a subsidiary of SAID Technologies Pvt. Ltd., Pune, with extensive experience leading technology, cybersecurity, and operational strategy for complex enterprise environments. Adept at building and scaling high-performing cybersecurity teams, implementing robust security frameworks across datacenter, cloud, and network infrastructures, and driving compliance with global standards including ISO 27001, PCI DSS, and SOC II. Demonstrated expertise in risk management, internal and external audits, vendor compliance, and security governance, ensuring enterprise-wide resilience and regulatory adherence. Leading the team of SOC NOC operations. Skilled in leading TechOps and DevOps operations, managing project delivery from scope definition to implementation, analyzing requirements, prioritizing tasks, identifying dependencies, and driving post-deployment support. Experienced in client engagement, portfolio management, escalations, and stakeholder communication, with a strong record of mentoring teams to adopt best practices, optimize performance, and achieve operational excellence.

IT Infrastructure & Service Delivery Management

- **Led design, assessment, and migration of cloud infrastructure** across AWS, Azure, and GCP, including cloud readiness evaluations, TCO analysis, and business case development and deployment. Defined modern cloud architecture for hybrid and multi-cloud environments with a focus on security, scalability, and cost-efficiency. Compliance ready and documentation.
- **Managed end-to-end infrastructure deployments** across Windows Server (2000–2025), Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, CentOS), and VMware/Hyper-V environments. Managed Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, SQL, Exchange, SharePoint, SCOM, and file/database servers across Dev, Test, and Production environments. Cloud maintenance and billing management.
- **Directed and managed global rollouts and network optimization** initiatives. Implemented ISO 27001 and ITIL-aligned frameworks, managed security systems, and endpoint security solutions (AV, Websense), and led Proof of Concept (PoC) initiatives to demonstrate emerging technologies. Successfully managed end-to-end projects involving multiple deliverables.
- **Service & Change Management:** Spearheaded implementation of ITIL-aligned Incident, Problem, and Change Management processes to maximize service uptime, enforce SLAs, and maintain a proactive disaster recovery and business continuity posture. Adaptability to guide teams through transitions, manage the teams and vendors across the lifecycle
- **Client Engagement & Pre-Sales:** Actively contributed to sales and pre-sales cycles including RFP responses, solution design, client presentations, and stakeholder management, lead generation, customer (CSAT), and long-term client retention.
- **IT Operations & Cost Optimization:** Directed cross-functional IT operations and project delivery within defined budgets and timelines. Enhanced process workflows to optimize resource utilization, improve delivery speed, and reduce operational costs through automation and strategic sourcing. Implement process improvements to reduce downtime and improve ROI.
- **Vendor & Stakeholder Management:** Managed strategic partnerships and vendor relationships, both locally and internationally, ensuring cost-effective procurement, SLA adherence, and alignment with business objectives.
- **Governance, Risk & Compliance:** Maintained enterprise-grade compliance with global standards including ISO 27001, ITIL v4, GDPR, and CCPA. Instituted quality assurance across project phases to ensure data security & privacy, operational excellence.

Highlights

- Coached staff from trainee level to team leaders on areas such as delivery & operations management, process & change management, RCA & risk analysis, pre- and post-production testing, monitoring, roll back operations & documentation.
- Directed the design and management of security controls across hybrid environments (Data Center, Cloud, Network). Oversaw Security Operations (SecOps), including incident response, threat hunting, and vulnerability management.
- Worked closely with CISO, CEO, senior management, PM, and stakeholders during the Security compliance building, Datacenter infrastructure upgrade to technologies like Cloud, Azure, AWS platforms, physical DC to cloud migrations.
- Managed multiple teams of 100+ personnel providing production support to technical operations, software, and application development for 17000 users of production & development revenue-based applications.
- Ramped up incident SLA adherence from 70% to 98% through daily reviews; improved recovery times for complex incidents by mentoring SMEs; 95% to resolved same day (up from 5% over 1-2 months)

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Associate Director - IntraEdge Technologies (US-INDIA M&A delivery - Project) from MAY 24 – OCT 2024

Senior Transformation Manager – AERIES Technology Group (ATG) from 2021 - 2024

Global IT Manager - Application Software Technologies (AST) from 2019 - 2021

Senior Consultant Infrastructure & Services - Net connect Global as a Freelance from 2019-2019

HEAD IT - Innoplexus Consulting Services Pvt. Ltd. In Pune from 2018-2018

Ministry of Works, Municipal Affairs and Urban Planning, Bahrain as a “Project Manager” from 2012-2018

System Admin - Codewalla Software Development Pvt. Ltd., Pune from 2010-2011

ACADEMIC DETAILS

- MBA in International Business from Wales Bridge University, California, USA with 3.58 GPA in 2014
- Bachelors’ information technology from Asherton University, Texas, USA with 3.44 GPA in 2013
- Advanced Diploma in Computer Hardware & Networking from Jetking Institute, Pune in 2003
- Vocational diploma Electrical & Electronics Technology from Govt. Tech H.S. & Jr. College, Pune in 1999
- SSC from Maharashtra board from Shri Shivaji Maratha High School, Pune in 1998

TECHNOLOGY SKILLS

OPERATING SYSTEMS & VIRTUALIZATION

- Modern OS Platforms: Windows Server 2025/2022/2019/2016, Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, Debian, CentOS, Fedora), MacOS
- Enterprise Virtualization: VMware vSphere/ESXi, vCenter, Microsoft Hyper-V – deployment, lifecycle management,
- performance tuning, Containerization & Orchestration - Docker, Kubernetes

CYBERSECURITY & THREAT MANAGEMENT

- Endpoint Protection & XDR: CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Defender for Endpoint, Sophos, McAfee ePO, Symantec, Dark Trace. OT security and compliance framework ICS & SCADA, physical safety measurements
- Network Security & Firewalls: Fortinet, SonicWALL, PFSense, SOPHOS UTM, Squid Proxy
- Email & Web Security: MIMECAST, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Proofpoint, FortiMail, Abnormal Security
- Security Governance: SIEM integration, secure configuration baselines, Zero Trust principles.

INFRASTRUCTURE, NETWORKING & IDENTITY

- Core Network Services: Cisco Routing & Switching, VLAN, VPN, SD-WAN, DNS, DHCP
- Windows Infrastructure: Active Directory, Group Policy, Certificate Services, File Services
- Identity & Access Management: Entra ID, LDAP, SSO/Federation, Role-based Access Control (RBAC)

PRODUCTIVITY & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

- Microsoft 365 Ecosystem: Exchange Online, SharePoint Online, Teams, OneDrive, Entra ID (Azure AD)
- Governance & Compliance: DLP, Conditional Access, MFA, Data Retention Policies

CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE & DEVOPS

- Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)
- Cloud-Native Skills: IaaS, PaaS, hybrid cloud deployment, cost optimization, landing zone setup, identity & access
- Management, PySpark, Airflow, Glue ETL, Athena, AWS CodePipeline, Jenkins, GitHub Actions
- DevOps & Automation Tools - Terraform, Ansible, CI/CD pipelines – GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps

BACKUP, STORAGE & DISASTER RECOVERY

- Enterprise Backup Solutions: Commvault, Veeam, Acronis, IDrive
- Storage Systems: Dell PowerStore, HPE, NetApp – SAN/NAS, iSCSI, Tape Autoloaders
- DR/BCP: End-to-end planning & testing – RPO/RTO alignment, regulatory compliance (esp. financial services)

WEB, DATABASE & APPLICATION HOSTING

- Web & Application Servers: IIS, Apache, NGINX
- Database Platforms: MongoDB, NoSQL, SQL Server – performance tuning, backup, HA
- Hosting & Monitoring: Web hosting lifecycle, SSL, app performance monitoring tools,
- Hosting and VPS platforms – Go daddy, Big Rock, Digital Ocean, AWS Amplify, Lightsail

SERVICE MANAGEMENT & IT GOVERNANCE

- ITSM Platforms: JIRA Service Management, ServiceNow, Confluence
- Frameworks & Standards: ITIL v4, ISO/IEC 27001, ISO 20000, NIST Cybersecurity
- Processes: Incident, Problem, Change Management – process optimization and automation

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAININGS

- CSM - Certified Scrum Master, Agile Projects Integrator
- ISO/IEC 20000 Foundation in IT Service Management, Compliance management
- PRINCE 2 Registered Practitioner and Foundation, Cyber Crime protection program
- ITIL V3 Expert MALC - ITSO, ITSM, ITIL V3 Foundation
- AWS Certified Solution Architect – Associate, RHCE - Red Hat Certified Engineer
- MCSA, MCSE – Server Infrastructure: Server 2012, SharePoint, Data Platform, SQL 2012, Power BI,
- Microsoft Specialist – Implementing Azure infrastructure Solutions & Private Cloud
- MCSA – SQL Server 2012, MCTS – System Center Configuration Manager 2012
- Training completed at PMP 5.3, AWS Cloud Practitioner Essentials Core services, Windows Business & Technical, AWS TCO and Cloud Economics Online, AWS Technical Professional, AWS Migration
- Generative AI mastermind from Outskill in 2026

PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of Birth: 5th December 1982

Address: Pune, Maharashtra, INDIA

Marital Status: Married

Languages known: English, Hindi & Marathi